

PROSPER AWUNI

Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Microsoft Defender | Entra ID | Azure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and experienced Threat Detection Engineer with over five years of enterprise security expertise, specialising in building high-impact detection capabilities using Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), and the Microsoft Defender suite. In my current senior security engineering role at the University of the Arts London, I design and maintain detection-as-code across the Microsoft security stack, including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, protecting an 8,000-user environment. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AAD) identity governance, Conditional Access policy engineering, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) deployment, and cloud-native log analysis within the Azure ecosystem. I am proficient in mapping detections to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, building Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, and conducting proactive threat hunting using advanced KQL. I am motivated by the opportunity to shape detection capabilities that protect sensitive data and business-critical systems at scale in a forward-thinking, data-driven organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Threat Detection and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and workbooks, KQL detection authoring, detection-as-code, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, alert tuning and signal optimisation
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, advanced hunting using KQL
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Identity Governance, Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **SOAR / Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps), automated alert triage, enrichment workflows, PowerShell scripting, SOAR-based incident response automation
- **Azure Cloud Security:** Azure Log Analytics workspace, Azure Monitor, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, cloud workload log ingestion and analysis
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Data Protection and Compliance:** Microsoft Purview familiarity, Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policy awareness, information governance
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast email gateway, anti-phishing, attachment sandboxing, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design and maintain threat detection capabilities using Microsoft Sentinel, authoring KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics across identity, endpoint, email, cloud, and application log sources.
- Build and tune detection-as-code: manage Sentinel analytics rules versioning, test detection logic against real attack patterns, and iterate based on threat intelligence and incident learnings.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using advanced KQL queries across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying adversarial activity and undetected threats within the environment.

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, tuning detection policies and performing deep-dive endpoint investigations.
- Engineer Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AAD) identity governance controls, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Identity Protection, and MFA enforcement.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, triage, and response workflows to improve mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Analyse Azure cloud logs via Log Analytics workspace, detecting anomalous activity across Azure workloads, privileged operations, and resource configuration changes.
- Lead incident response engagements following NIST 800-61 lifecycle with MITRE ATT&CK technique mapping; produce post-incident reports and detection improvement recommendations.
- Collaborate with infrastructure and application teams to onboard new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, extending detection coverage across the attack surface.
- Manage vulnerability assessment programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; prioritise critical findings and co-ordinate remediation with asset owners.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Developed and tuned Microsoft Sentinel KQL analytics rules and alert queries, improving threat detection quality and reducing analyst workload from false positives.
- Performed day-to-day alert triage and investigation in Microsoft Sentinel, managing incidents from initial detection through to containment and post-incident analysis.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) operations: alert triage, policy management, and guided remediation for endpoint threats.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory configuration, including Conditional Access authoring, MFA deployment, and SSO integration for enterprise applications.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM implementation, configuring privileged session management and access policies for administrative accounts.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus; prepared risk-rated remediation reports for infrastructure and application teams.
- Supported incident response using NIST 800-61, contributing to forensic investigations and MITRE ATT&CK-aligned post-incident reviews.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security tooling and infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) fintech platform, implementing endpoint protection, identity and access management controls, and security monitoring.
- Configured Azure Active Directory (AAD) and MFA for cloud services, reducing identity risk across the organisation.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for security operations and infrastructure management tasks.
- Supported ISO 27001 audit preparation, contributing to evidence collection and internal security reviews.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a Microsoft Sentinel detection engineering library of 40+ KQL analytics rules at UAL, all mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-priority threats.
- Engineered end-to-end SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that automated phishing investigation and response, reducing analyst handling time per incident significantly.
- Led Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA deployment across 8,000 users, achieving full identity coverage in a phased rollout that maintained business continuity.
- Designed Azure cloud log ingestion pipelines into Microsoft Sentinel, extending detection coverage across Azure workloads and privileged administrative activities.
- Conducted proactive threat hunts using KQL across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike, surfacing previously undetected credential abuse and lateral movement in the environment.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)